Little Lab Coats

👪 🪞 👁️ You Look Like Your Parents

Parents and Offspring Unit, Lesson 1

📚 **Grade:** 1st Grade ⏱️ **Duration:** 45 minutes 🔬 **Subject:** Life Science 📋 **NGSS Standard:** 1-LS3-1

Every face in your family tells a story about inherited traits passed down through generations.

📋 **NGSS Standard:**
1-LS3-1 — Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.

🎯 Learning Objectives

- Observe that offspring look **similar** but **not identical** to their parents.
- Identify inherited traits such as eye color, hair color, ear shape, nose shape, and freckles.
- Understand that traits come from both parents, creating a unique combination in each offspring.

📦 Materials

🏠 What You Need (Household Only)

- Family photos (or draw faces)
- Paper and crayons
- A mirror (for the "look-alike" activity)

✅ *No materials to buy! Everything you need is already at home.*

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🐣🐾🦆 Baby Animals and Their Needs

Parents and Offspring Unit, Lesson 2

📚 **Grade:** 1st Grade ⏱️ **Duration:** 45 minutes 🔬 **Subject:** Life Science 📋 **NGSS Standard:** 1-LS3-1

Baby animals need the same things adult animals need. But they often need a lot more help getting them!

📋 **NGSS Standard:**
1-LS3-1 — Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.

🎯 Learning Objectives

- Identify that baby animals have the same **basic needs** as adults: food, water, shelter, and safety.
- Recognize that parents help meet their offspring's needs, especially when babies are young and vulnerable.
- Observe that some baby animals look very different from their parents (metamorphosis), yet still share the same needs.

📦 Materials

🏠 What You Need (Household Only)

- Paper and crayons
- Optional: a nature documentary description from the parent (no screen required)

✅ *All household items, nothing to purchase.*

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🐻 🐧 🦘 How Animal Parents Protect Offspring

Parents and Offspring Unit, Lesson 3

📚 **Grade:** 1st Grade ⏱️ **Duration:** 45 minutes 🔬 **Subject:** Life Science 📋 **NGSS Standard:** 1-LS3-1

Every parent animal has its own special way of keeping babies safe. Some carry them, some huddle over them, some guard the nest.

📋 **NGSS Standard:**
1-LS3-1 — Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.

🎯 Learning Objectives

- Identify specific behaviors that animal parents use to **protect their young**.
- Connect parental protection strategies to offspring **survival**.
- Begin to distinguish between protection behaviors that use the parent's **body** vs. their **actions**.

📦 Materials

🏠 What You Need (Household Only)

- Paper, pencil, and crayons

✅ *Everything you need is already at home!*

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🐦🦮🎓 Teaching: When Parents Show What to Do

Parents and Offspring Unit, Lesson 4

📚 **Grade:** 1st Grade ⏱️ **Duration:** 45 minutes 🔬 **Subject:** Life Science 📋 **NGSS Standard:** 1-LS3-1

Some things animals just know. Other things they have to be taught. Can you tell the difference?

📋 **NGSS Standard:**
1-LS3-1 — Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.

🎯 Learning Objectives

- Distinguish between **inherited behaviors (instincts)** and **learned behaviors**.
- Recognize examples of parent animals teaching skills to offspring.
- Connect the concept of learning to human experiences of being taught by parents.

📦 Materials

🏠 What You Need (Household Only)

- Paper and pencil
- Optional: a simple skill to practice "teaching" a younger sibling during the lesson (for example, stacking blocks or folding paper)

✅ *No materials to purchase.*

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🌻🌱🍎 Plant Parenting

Parents and Offspring Unit, Lesson 5

📚 **Grade:** 1st Grade ⏱️ **Duration:** 45 minutes 🔬 **Subject:** Life Science 📋 **NGSS Standard:** 1-LS3-1

Every seed holds a tiny recipe for a new plant, passed down from its parent. What will grow from yours?

📋 **NGSS Standard:**
1-LS3-1 — Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.

🎯 Learning Objectives

- Recognize that plants also pass traits to offspring through **seeds**.
- Observe that plant offspring resemble the parent plant in shape, color, and type.
- Understand that seeds carry **"instructions"** (DNA) for growing a new plant just like the parent.

📦 Materials

🏠 What You Need (Household Only)

- 2-3 different seeds from your kitchen (beans, peas, corn, etc.)
- Paper plates (one per seed type)
- Magnifying glass (optional, but cool)
- Paper and pencil
- One small cup or container with soil (for planting one seed in the end)

🌱 *All seeds can come from your kitchen! Dried beans and peas are ideal.*

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🌿🐾📖 Patterns of Parent and Offspring Behavior

Parents and Offspring Unit, Lesson 6

📚 **Grade:** 1st Grade ⏱️ **Duration:** 45 minutes 🔬 **Subject:** Life Science 📋 **NGSS Standard:** 1-LS3-1

Across every living thing on Earth, the same pattern repeats: offspring resemble their parents, but are never exactly the same.

📋 **NGSS Standard:**
1-LS3-1 Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.

🎯 Learning Objectives

- Identify **patterns** across multiple species showing that offspring resemble their parents in important ways.
- Synthesize unit concepts about inheritance, variation, protection, and learning to describe what all parents and offspring have in common.

📦 Materials

🏠 What You Need

- Paper
- Pencil
- Crayons

✅ *No materials to buy. Everything you need is already at home.*

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